



Making waves: Vidarbha's left-arm spinner Harsh Dubey topped the Ranji wicket charts last season with 69 wickets at an average of under 17. EMMANUAL YOGINI

base price of Rs 30 lakh of an uncapped IPL player. This imbalance can be reduced to a great extent if other associations, like Mumbai, match the BCCI's payments to Ranji players. Sadly, this doesn't happen as most associations are happy to keep the huge multi-crore subsidy that the BCCI gives in their bank and hardly even use it for the development of the game in their jurisdiction. Since BCCI fees reach players only after the Ranji season ends, State associations should also pay them an equivalent amount. After all, in which profession does one get paid months after the job has been done? Hopefully, in the next season, more and more State associations will come forward to bolster the income of their Ranji players and incentivise them to play at

their best.

To end on a non-cricketing note, it was good to tick off the last and final item on my bucket list of watching world sports events by being there on the final day of the Augusta Masters.

Rory McIlroy has been trying for the last 11 years to win the tournament and receive the green jacket, and thereby complete a career Grand Slam of the four golf Majors. He finally did that in a play-off with Englishman Justin Rose. My first trip to the French Open Tennis and the US Open Tennis resulted in Stan Wawrinka winning those titles for the first time and now with McIlroy also winning the Augusta Masters for the first time, maybe anybody who is coveting a title for the first time should invite me as their lucky charm.



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